SOMIAH
GROUP

USER GUIDE

Somasu

Shared lists, the family calendar, bookings and notifications, step by step

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Welcome to Somasu

Somasu is the Somiah family's own planner. The name blends Somiah with Abusua, the Twi word for family. It keeps the shopping list, the family calendar and the things we share in one place, and it's the same on everyone's phone, tablet and computer. Add milk on your phone and it's on everyone else's list a second later.

It's private. Only people on the family list can sign in, and nothing is shared outside the family.

Quick start

I want to...	Go to	How
Add something to the shopping list	Lists	Type it in the box at the top and press Enter.
Tick things off in the shop	Lists	Tap the circle next to each item.
Put something on the family calendar	Calendar	Tap the + button, fill in what, when and who.
Be reminded before an event	Calendar	Choose a time under "Remind whoever it's for".
Book the car (or anything we share)	Bookings	Pick it, then tap Book. Somasu stops double bookings.
Get notifications on my phone	Family	Tap Turn on under Notifications.
Find help on any page	? Help button	Opens this guide at the right section, with short videos.

THREE THINGS TO REMEMBER

Install it. Add Somasu to your home screen so it opens like an app (page 4).

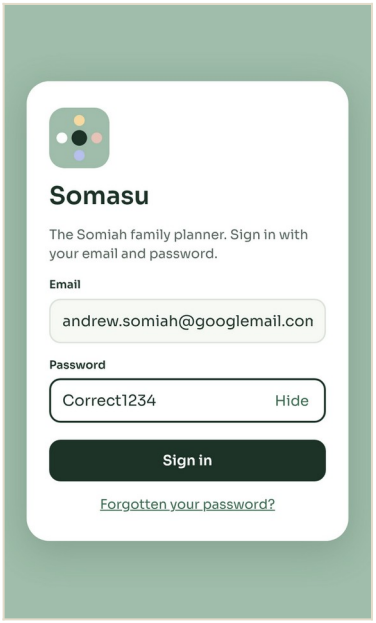
Say who it's for. Tag events with the right people so the right phones get the reminder.

Turn notifications on once per device. Each phone and computer has its own setting.

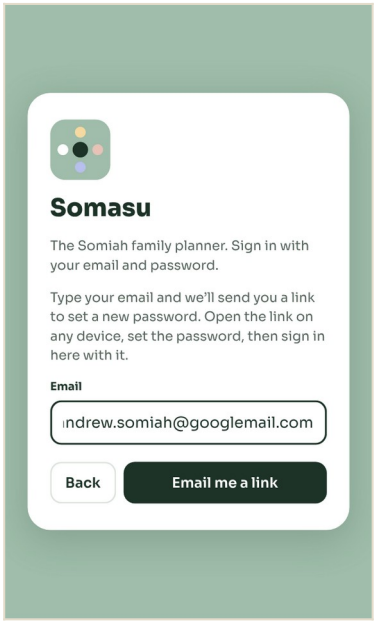
Getting started

Signing in

Open the Somasu link Andy sent you. Type your email address and the password Andy gave you, then tap **Sign in**. Somasu remembers you on that device, so you won't need to sign in again unless you sign out. Let your phone or password manager save the password when it offers. To check what you've typed, tap **Show** in the password box; tap **Hide** to cover it again. On a computer, a red note tells you if Caps Lock is on.



Sign in: tap Show to check your password



Forgotten your password?

FORGOTTEN YOUR PASSWORD?

Tap **Forgotten your password?** on the sign-in page and type your email. You'll get an email with a link: open it on any device, choose a new password, then sign in to Somasu with it. On iPhone the link opens in Safari; that's fine, the new password works in the installed app straight away.

Change your password any time under **Family › Change password**. Passwords need 10 or more characters with a capital letter, a small letter and a number.

Installing the app

Somasu isn't in the app stores. You install it straight from the website, which takes ten seconds:

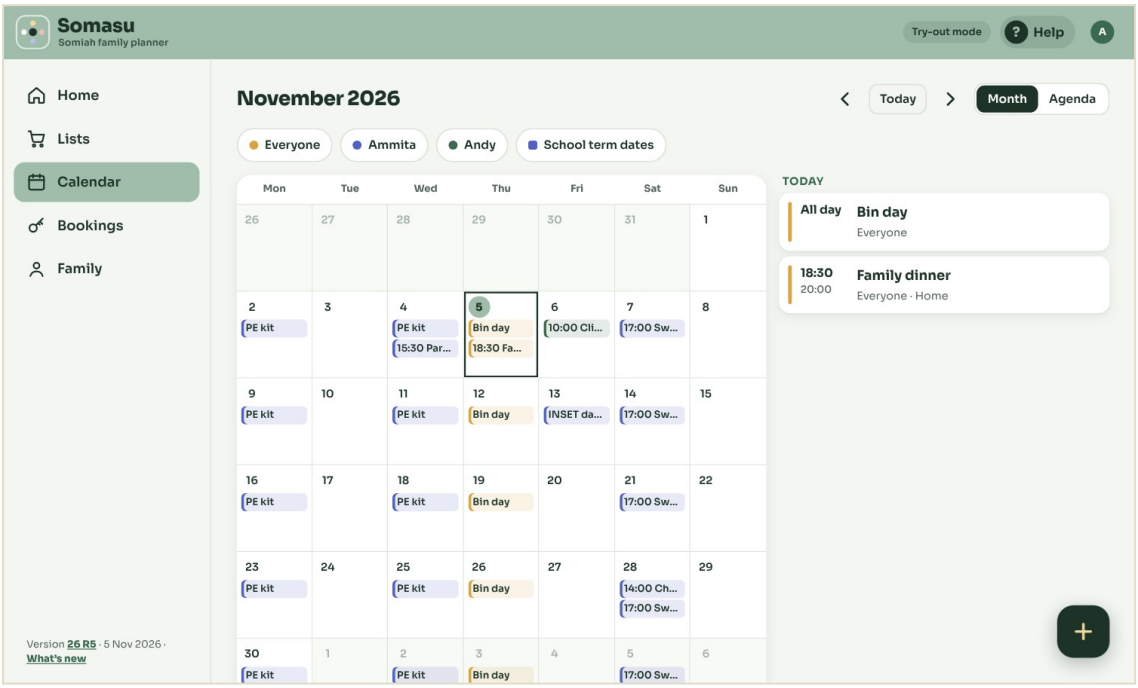
Device	What to do
iPhone or iPad	Open the link in **Safari**. Tap the Share button, then **Add to Home Screen**. Open Somasu from the new icon.

Device	What to do
Android	Open the link in **Chrome**. Tap ⋮ then **Install app** (or **Add to Home screen**).
Windows, Mac or Linux	Open the link in **Chrome** or **Edge**. Click the install icon at the right of the address bar.

The same steps are inside the app under **Family › Install on your phone or computer**.

Finding your way around

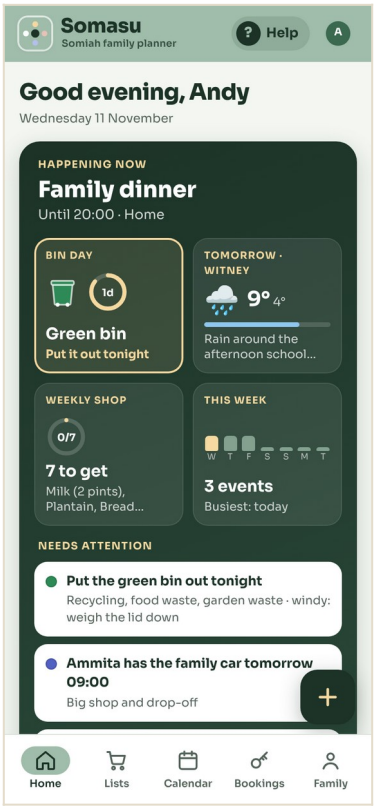
The tabs along the bottom (down the left side on a computer) take you to **Home**, **Lists**, **Calendar**, **Bookings** and **Family**. The dark **+** button always adds something to the page you're on. The **? Help** button at the top opens help and short videos.



Somasu on a computer: the same app, with more room.

Home

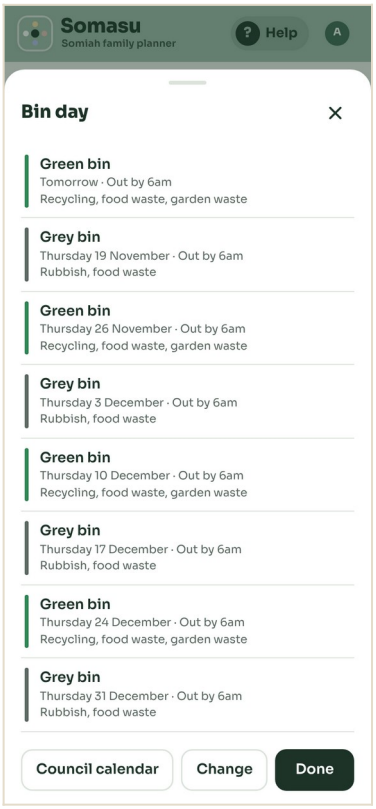
Home opens with your day in a dark green panel. At the top, in large type, is what's Next up (or Happening now), with the time and place. Under it are four tiles, each with a small picture: Bin day (a coloured bin and a ring counting down the days), Weather (today's high and low and a rain bar), your shopping list (a ring that fills as you tick things off) and This week (a bar for each day, so busy days stand out). Below them, Needs attention lists anything that needs doing soon, such as putting a bin out or someone having the car tomorrow; it disappears when there's nothing. Under the panel: today, the lists, what's coming up and what's booked. Tap anything to open it.



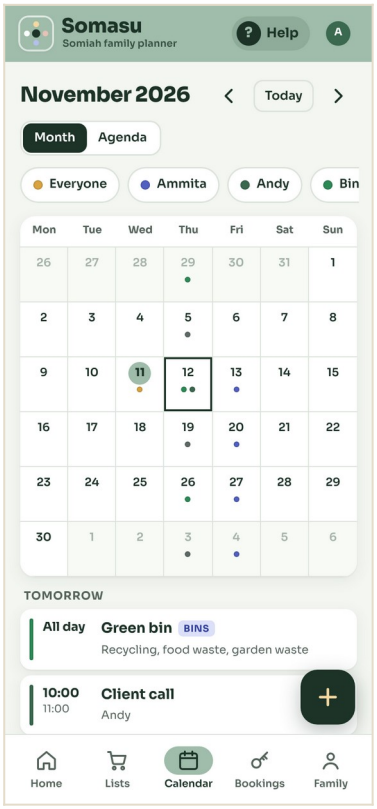
Home: next up, your four tiles and Needs attention

Bin day

Once an admin has set it up, Somasu shows bin day for you: the Bin day tile on Home says which bin goes out next and turns gold the day before (“Put it out tonight”), and each collection appears in the calendar. Tap the tile for the next eight weeks, with what goes in each bin and a link to the council’s own calendar. Bank holiday changes show as moved.



Tap the tile: the next eight weeks

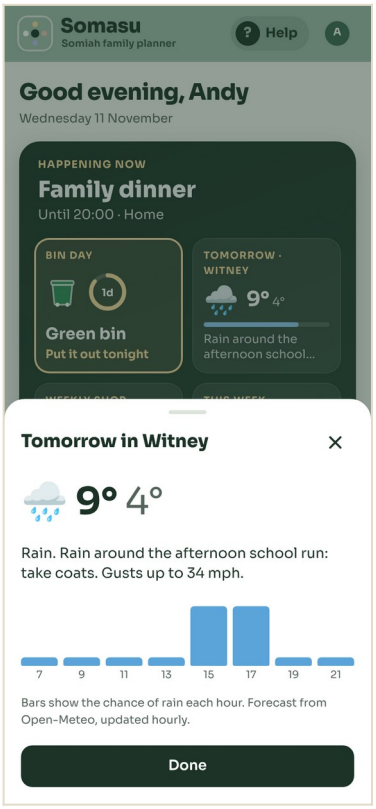


Collections in the calendar, labelled Bins

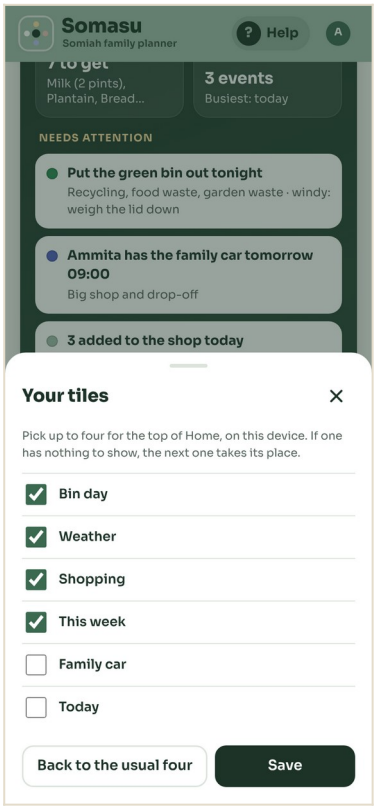
Somasu can also remind everyone at 7pm the evening before. Turn the reminder on or off for your own phone under Family › Notifications › Bin day. Tap Bins in the calendar's row of names to hide collections from the calendar.

Weather and your tiles

The Weather tile shows today's forecast for Witney (tomorrow's after 6pm), with a nudge such as "Rain around the afternoon school run: take coats". Tap it for the chance of rain hour by hour. The forecast comes free from Open-Meteo; only the town is sent, never your address.



Tap Weather: rain hour by hour



Choose tiles: pick your own four

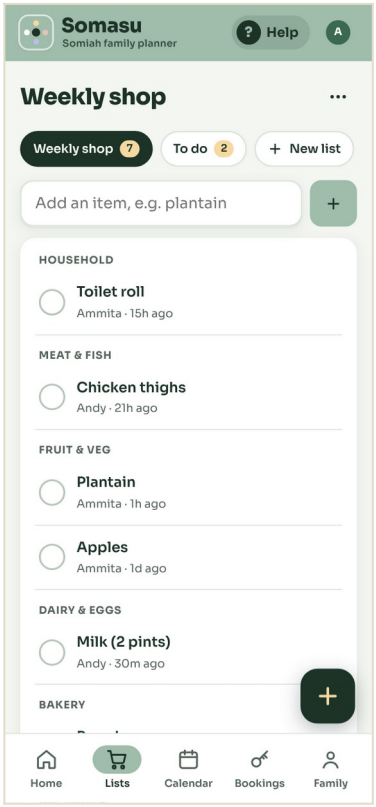
Tap Choose tiles at the bottom of the panel to pick the four you want: Bin day, Weather, Shopping, This week, the first thing you book (the family car) or Today. Your choice is saved on that phone or computer only. If a tile has nothing to show, the next one on the list steps in, so there are always four. Back to the usual four resets them.

Lists

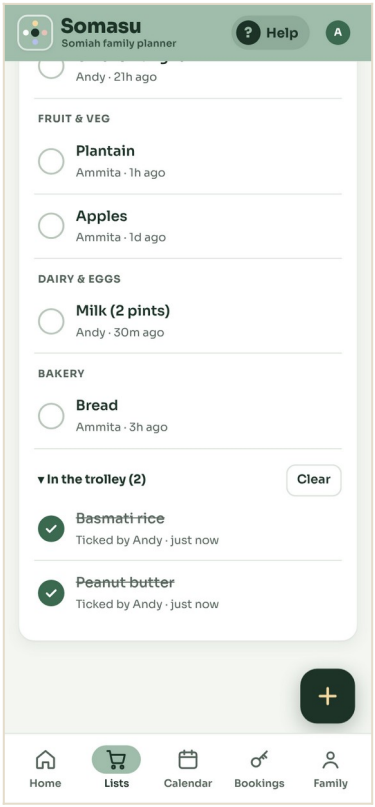
Lists are shared. Whatever you add, everyone sees straight away, along with who added it and when.

Adding and ticking off

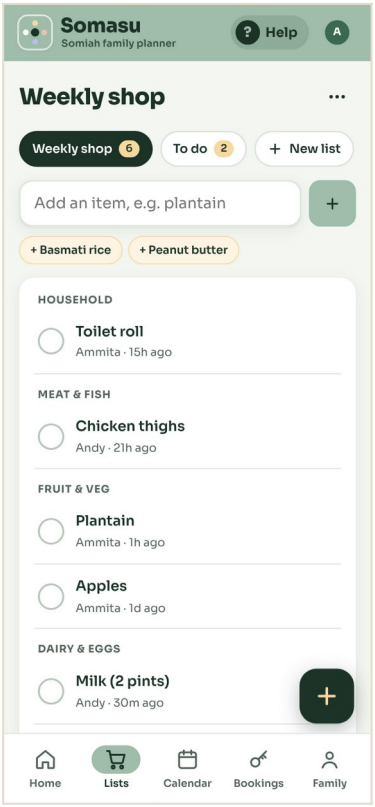
Type in the box at the top and press Enter (or tap the green +). On a shopping list, Somasu sorts items by aisle (fruit and veg, dairy, cupboard and so on) so you can work round the shop. Tap the circle to tick an item off. Ticked items move to **In the trolley** at the bottom, so someone else in another aisle can see what you've already got.



Items sorted by aisle



Ticked items go in the trolley



Buy again from past shops

When you're done, tap **Clear** next to In the trolley. Cleared items disappear, but Somasu remembers them and shows them as **Buy again** buttons above the list. Tap one to add it back in a single tap.

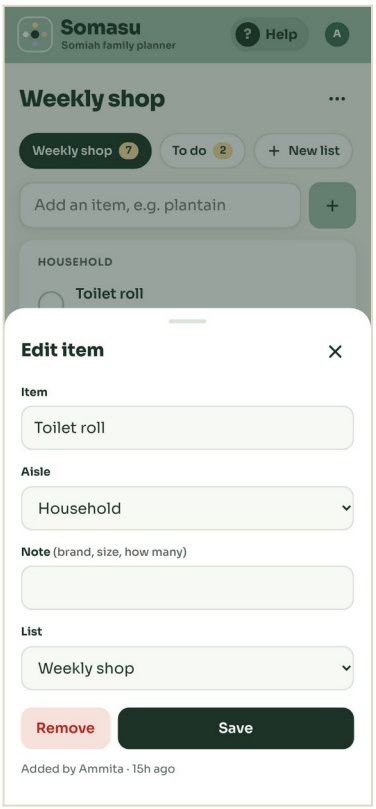
Changing an item

Tap the item's name to change it, add a note (brand, size, how many), move it to another aisle or another list, or remove it.

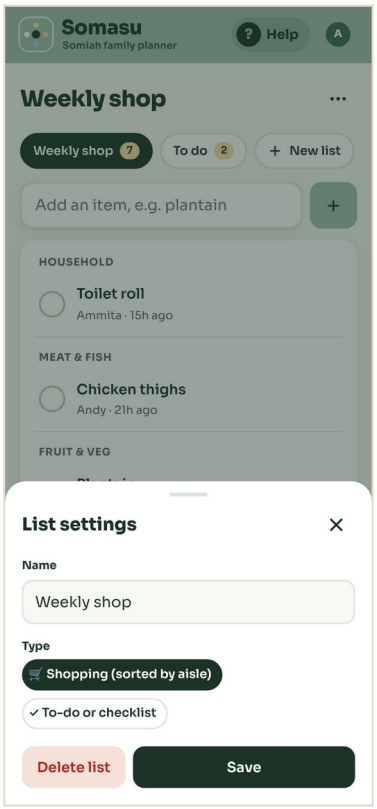
More lists

Tap **New list** for a separate list, for example a Costco run or holiday packing. Choose **Shopping** for a list sorted by aisle, or **To-do** for a simple checklist. The ··· button next to the

list name renames or deletes it. Deleting a list removes it for everyone, so Somasu asks first.



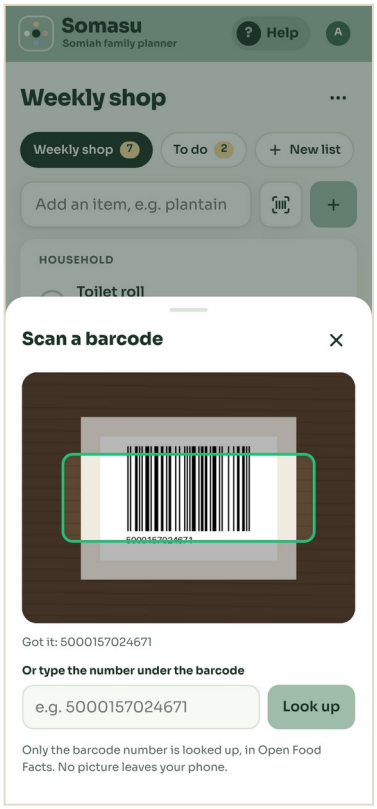
Edit an item



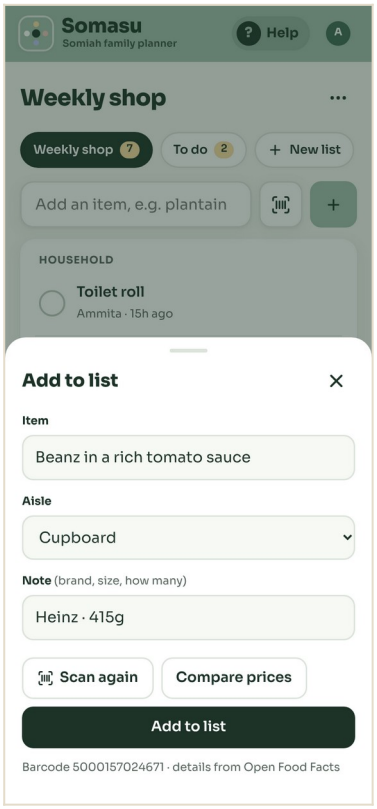
List settings

Scanning a barcode

On a shopping list, tap the scan button (the barcode next to the add box) and point your phone's camera at the barcode on the packet. Hold it steady for a second. When the frame turns green, Somasu looks the product up and fills in its name, brand, size and aisle. Check them, change anything you like, then tap **Add to list**.



Scanning: the frame turns green when it's read



Name, size and aisle filled in for you

The first time, your phone asks if Somasu may use the camera: tap **Allow**. If the barcode won't scan (shiny packets, poor light), type the number printed under it instead and tap **Look up**. If a product isn't known yet, type its name and it's added just the same.

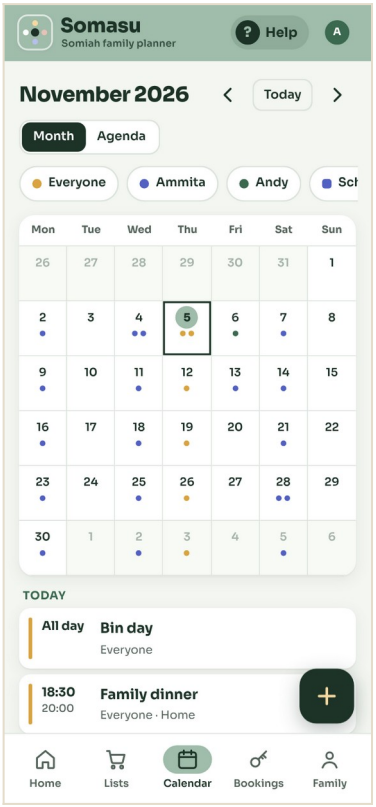
Product details come from Open Food Facts, a free, open product database. Only the barcode number is looked up: no picture leaves your phone, and nothing is saved.

Comparing prices

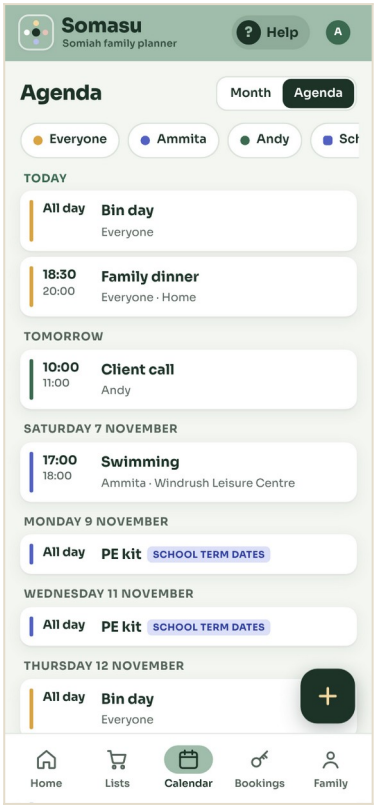
Tap any item on a shopping list, or a product you've just scanned, then tap **Compare prices**. Trolley.co.uk, a free UK price comparison site, opens with that item, showing what the main supermarkets charge. Somasu itself doesn't store prices.

Calendar

The family calendar shows everyone's plans in one place. Each person has their own colour; gold means it's for everyone. Use the coloured buttons under the month to show or hide people. Calendars linked from Google, Outlook or school show with a small label (SCHOOL, for example). If the same event is in more than one person's linked calendar, Somasu shows it once, with the faces of everyone it belongs to; tap it to see which calendars it's in.



Month view: tap a day to see it

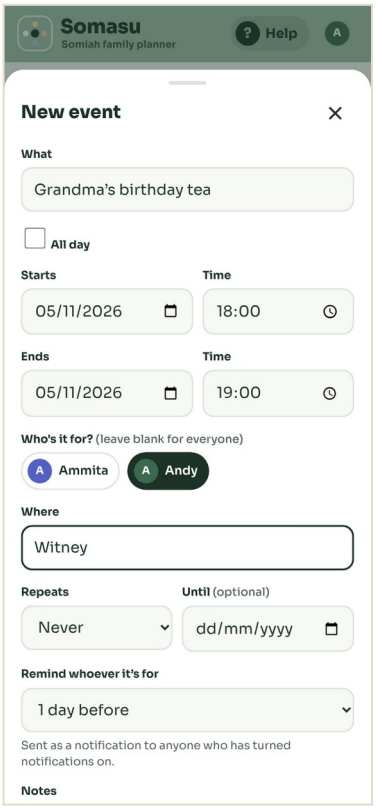


Agenda: the next 60 days as a list

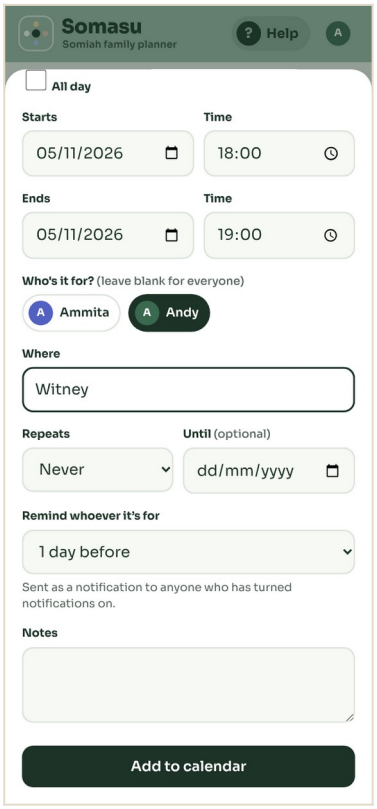
Month shows the whole month with dots for each event (names on a bigger screen). Tap a day to see its events underneath; on a phone, tap the same day again to add something to it. **Agenda** lists everything coming up, day by day.

Adding an event

Tap **+**. Fill in what it is and when. Tick **All day** for things like birthdays and days out. Under **Who's it for?** tap the people it involves, or leave everyone unselected if it's for the whole family. Add where, notes, and how often it repeats.



A new event



Repeats and reminder

Reminders

Pick a time under **Remind whoever it's for**: when it starts, 15 or 30 minutes, 1 or 2 hours, a day or a week before. The people it's for get a notification, as long as they've turned notifications on. All-day events are reminded at 8am, so a "1 day before" reminder for bin day arrives at 8am the day before.

Changing or deleting

Tap an event to change it. **Delete** on a repeating event asks whether to remove just that day (say swimming is off this week) or every time.

Adding to your own calendar

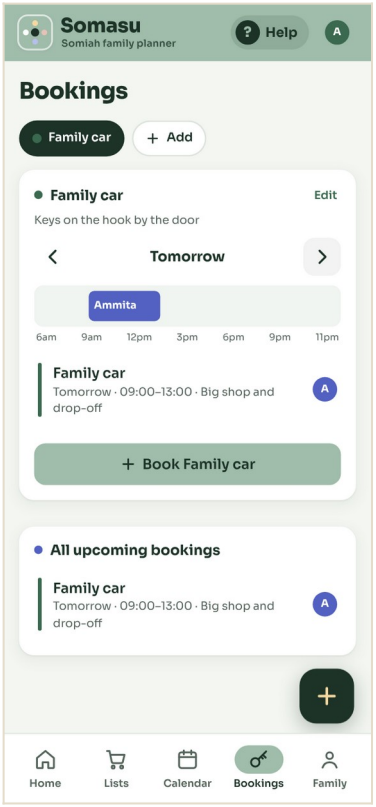
Open an event and tap **My calendar** to add it to the calendar app on your phone or computer, with its repeats.

Linked calendars

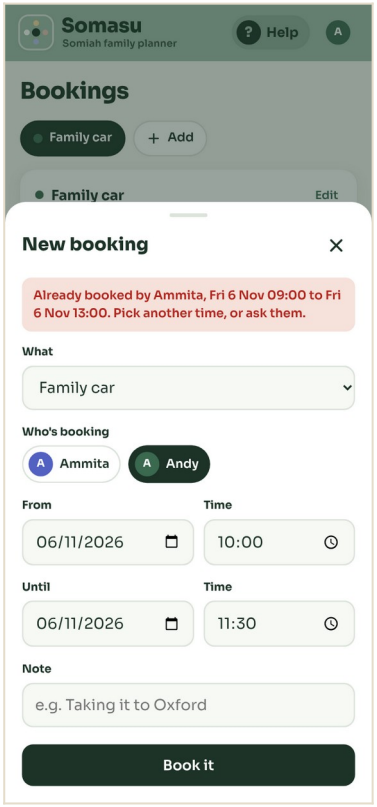
Events from linked calendars (your work Google calendar, the school's term dates and so on) appear alongside family events but can't be changed in Somasu. Tap one to see its details. Change it in the calendar it came from. How to link one is on page 14.

Bookings

Bookings are for anything the family shares: the car, the spare room, a holiday home. Somasu shows who has it when and won't let two people book the same time.



Who has the car, and when



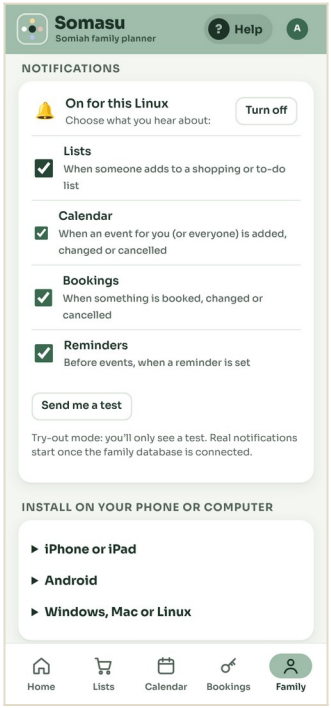
Somasu stops double bookings

1. Pick the thing at the top (Family car, for example).
2. Use the arrows to move between days. The bar shows the day from 6am to 11pm, coloured by who has it.
3. Tap **Book** (or +). Choose who's booking, from and until (it can run over several days), and add a note.
4. Tap **Book it**. If it clashes with another booking, Somasu says who has it and when, so you can pick another time or talk to them.

Tap a booking to change or cancel it. **All upcoming bookings** lists everything booked from now on.

Notifications

Notifications tell you when something changes without you having to open the app. You never get notified about your own changes.



Choose what you hear about

1. Go to **Family** and scroll to **Notifications**.
2. Tap **Turn on for this…** (it names your device) and allow notifications when your phone or browser asks.
3. Untick anything you don't want: list additions, calendar changes for you, bookings, reminders or bin day.
4. Tap **Send me a test** to check it works.

You hear about	For example
Lists	"Ammita added Plantain, Rice and 2 more" (several items added together arrive as one notification)
Calendar	An event for you, or for everyone, being added, changed or cancelled
Bookings	"Ammita booked it for Andy · Mon 2 Nov 09:00–13:00"
Reminders	"In 30 minutes · 17:00 · Leisure centre"
Bin day	"🗑️ Green bin tomorrow · Recycling, food waste, garden waste · Out by 6am", at 7pm the evening before

ON IPHONE AND IPAD

Notifications only work once Somasu is installed on the Home Screen (page 4) and opened from there. iOS 16.4 or later is needed.

Each device is separate: turn notifications on for your phone and your computer if you want both. Tapping a notification opens Somasu on the right list, day or booking. Turn them off at any time from the same place.

Family and settings

The **Family** tab shows who's using this device, the family members and their colours, linked calendars, things to book, bin day, notifications and install instructions. Admins can add and change family members; everyone else sees the list.

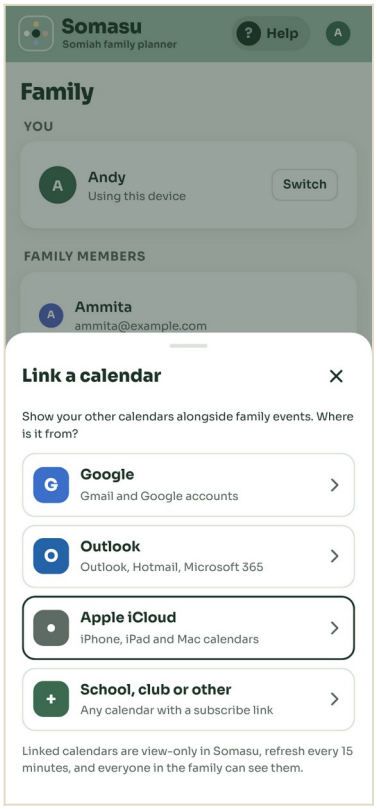
Linking a calendar

Tap **Link a calendar** on the Family page and pick where the calendar lives: **Google**, **Outlook** (including Hotmail and Microsoft 365), **Apple iCloud** or **School, club or other**. Somasu shows just the two or three steps for that service, with a button that opens the right settings page. Copy the calendar's link there, come back and tap **Paste**. Somasu checks the link straight away, reads the calendar's name, shows how many events it found and picks a colour. Tap **Link it**, then **Link another calendar** to add the next one.

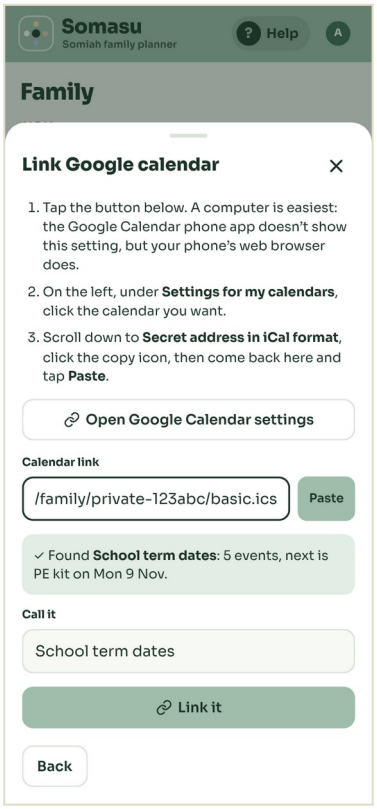
Calendar	The link you need
Google	**Secret address in iCal format**, in the calendar's settings (easiest on a computer)
Outlook / Microsoft 365	The **ICS** link from Settings › Calendar › Shared calendars › Publish a calendar
Apple iCloud	Calendar app › Calendars › ⓘ › **Public Calendar** › Share Link
School or club	A link called Subscribe, iCal or Add to calendar, or one ending in .ics

If you paste the wrong kind of link (Google's page address, or Outlook's HTML link), Somasu says which one to copy instead.

Linked calendars refresh every 15 minutes, and everyone in the family can see them, so only link calendars you're happy to share.



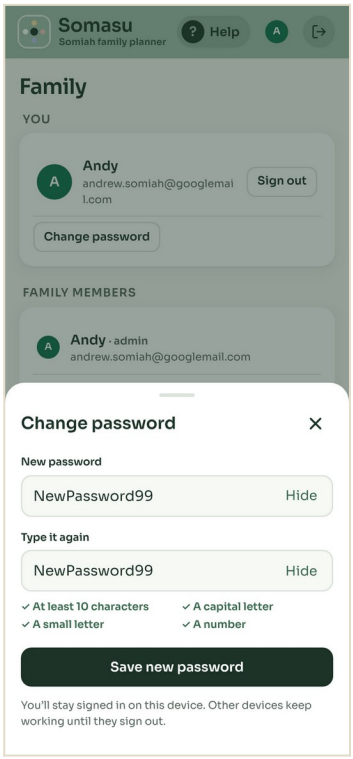
Pick where it lives



Paste, check, link

Your password

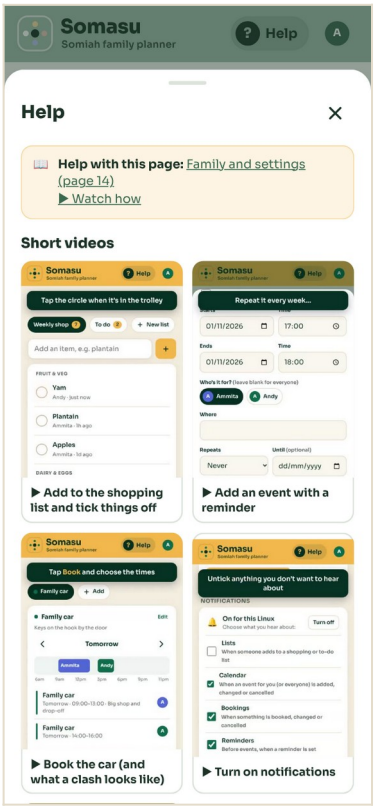
Tap **Change password** under You on the Family page. Type the new password twice; the ticks show when it meets all four rules (10 or more characters, a capital, a small letter and a number). You stay signed in on that device. Every password box has a **Show** button, so you can check both match before you save.



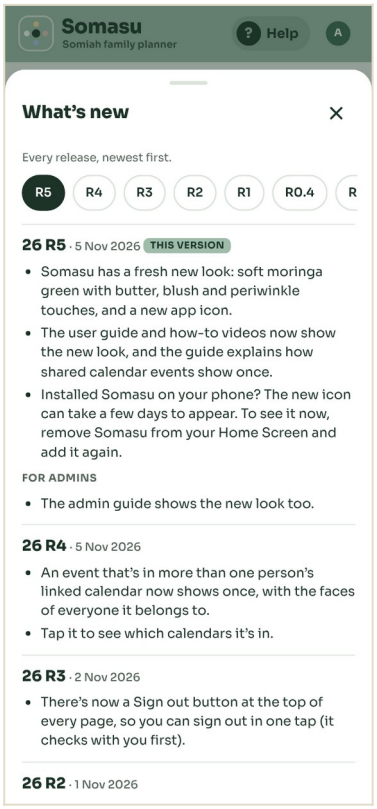
Change password: Show on each box

Help, videos and What's new

The **? Help** button at the top opens help for the page you're on: a link to the right section of this guide, a **Watch how** video where there is one, and seven short silent videos (lists, adding an event with a reminder, booking, notifications, linking a calendar, signing in and passwords, and scanning a barcode). The version line at the bottom of Home and the Family page shows which version you're using; tap **What's new** to see what changed in each release. Something not working? Tap Report a problem (at the bottom of Home and the Family page, or in Help). It opens an email to the family admin with the page, version and device already filled in; just say what happened.



Help



What's new

Your data

Download a backup saves everything as a file. Signing out removes your notifications from that device. Somasu keeps your data in the family database in London; nothing is sold, shared or used for adverts.

Questions and fixes

If…	Try this
My password doesn't work	Tap Show to see what you typed, and on a computer check for the red "Caps Lock is on" note. Then check the email address, or use Forgotten your password? on the sign-in page. Too many wrong tries locks sign-in for a few minutes.
The reset email doesn't arrive	Check spam and wait a few minutes. Only a few emails can be sent an hour. Or ask Andy to set a new password for you.
It says my email isn't set up	Ask Andy (or another admin) to add you to the family list.
I don't get notifications	Family › Notifications: is it on for this device? Tap Send me a test. On iPhone, open Somasu from the Home Screen icon, not Safari. Check your phone's Settings › Notifications › Somasu.
Someone else's change hasn't appeared	Pull down or switch tabs; Somasu also refreshes whenever you come back to it. Check you're online.
A linked calendar shows ⚠️	The link has stopped working. Copy a fresh private link from the original calendar and update it under Family › Linked calendars.
I can't book a time	Someone already has it. Somasu tells you who. Ask them, or pick another time.
Something looks wrong after an update	Close Somasu completely and open it again. The new version loads on the next open.

Still stuck? Ask Andy.